



Comparatives and Superlatives Podcast

Gate 2 – The Booking Desk

Welcome to Gate 2

The Booking Desk

Imagine you have **12 browser tabs** open for 12 different hotels.

You don't just want a good one; you want the **absolute best**.

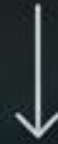


The Ultimate Winner

We must shift from simply comparing two options to finding the **single best** from many.



To do this, we use words called **superlatives**.



These are words ending in **-est**,
like cheapest or busiest.



The Unique Maximum

The word that causes massive headaches for learners.

It is not optional decoration; it means the **THE** **unique maximum**.

There can only be **one maximum** at the top.

A Cheapest Hotel?

Saying a cheapest hotel is a **total contradiction**.

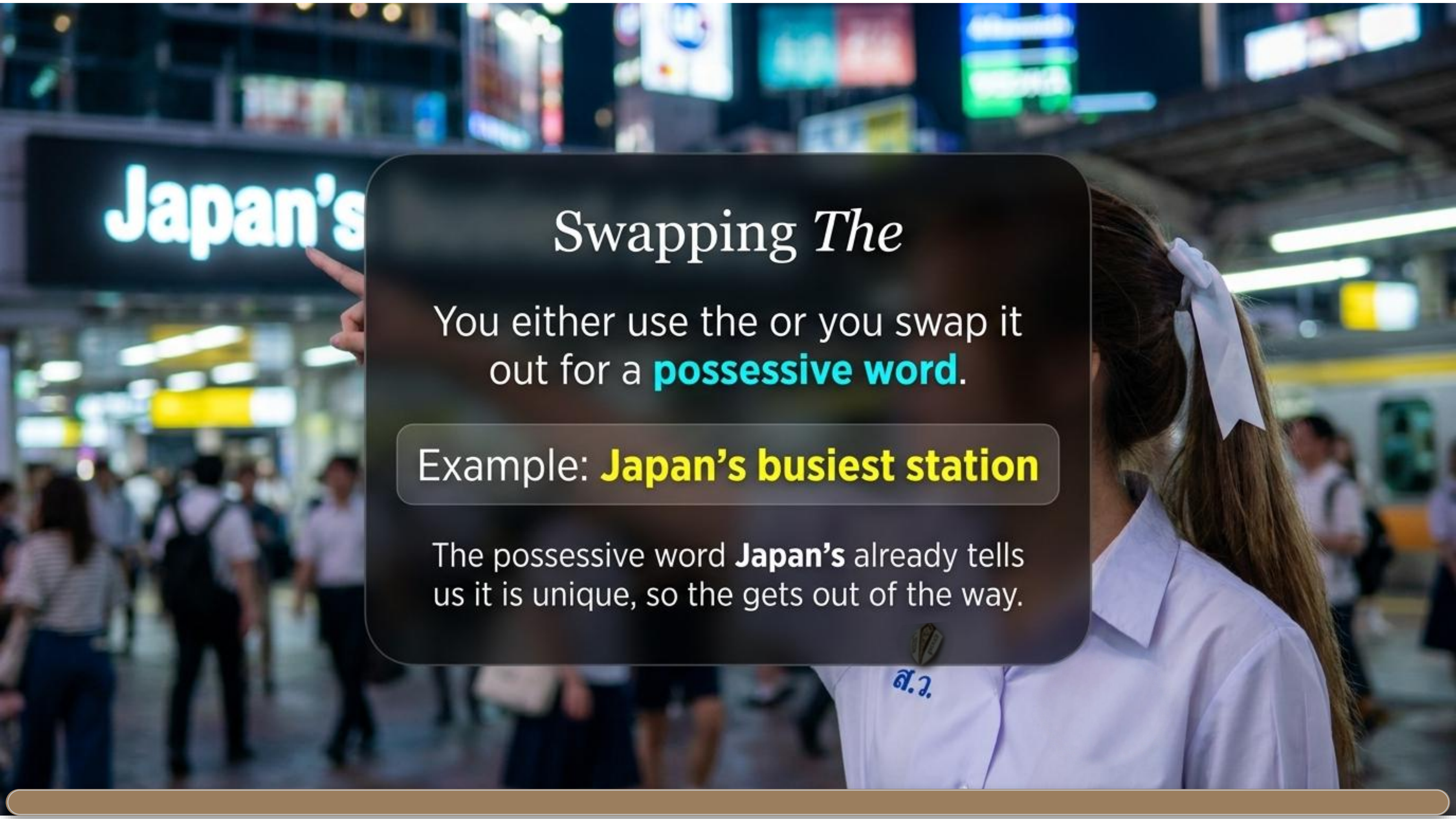
A

means one of
several.

-est

means the one
and only.

You cannot say both at the exact same time.

A background image of a busy Japanese train station at night. A large, illuminated sign on the left reads "Japan's". In the foreground, the back of a person with long brown hair tied in a ponytail with a white bow is visible. They are wearing a white school uniform shirt with a small blue pin and Thai text "ส.ว." on the left chest. The station is filled with people and bright lights from various signs and tracks.

Japan's

Swapping *The*

You either use the or you swap it out for a **possessive word**.

Example: **Japan's busiest station**

The possessive word **Japan's** already tells us it is unique, so the gets out of the way.

Naming the Race

A winner needs a **race**.

You have to define what group the winner is actually racing in.

Saying the busiest airport means nothing until you **name the group**.

Physical Boundaries

For places, we use the word **in**.
It acts like a physical boundary.

Example: The busiest airport **in Asia**
(physically inside the borders).

Fractions of a Total

For things or periods of time, we use the word **of**.

We treat it as a **fraction of a total**.

Example 1: The longest **of the three tunnels**.

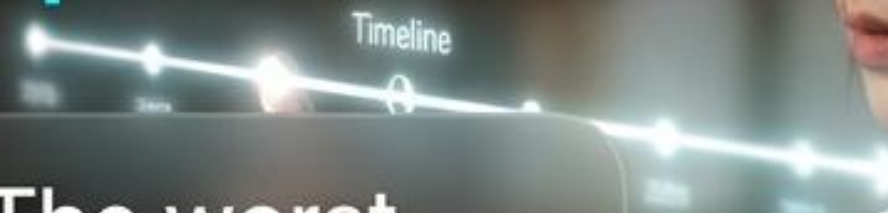
Example 2: The finest meal **of the holiday**.

The Present Perfect

If the group is your own life experience,
use the **present perfect tense**.

Example: The worst
hotel **I have ever stayed in.**

This grammar specifically connects
the **past to right now.**



Why Use Have?

Your life experience is everything that has happened up to **right now**.

By saying *have ever stayed in*, you keep that group **physically tied** to your life today.





Near the Top

What if a place did not win first prize, but is just near the top?

People often incorrectly say: "One of the busiest **station**" (Singular).

This is a major **grammatical pitfall.**



Pure Mechanics

The phrase 'one of the' **reaches into a group** to pull out one member.

A group of one is **not a group**.

Therefore, the noun naming the group simply **must be plural**.

Enforcing the Plural

Our research insists on
the plural form.

Correct:
one of the busiest stations

Correct:
one of the cheapest hotels





The Irregular Suspects

We frequently use common adjectives like **good, bad, far, little, many, and much.**

Ironically, you don't look for the "most good" hotel; you look for the **best.**

Why do these words have weird, **irregular forms**?



Shielded by Usage

**High frequency
protects
irregularity.**

This is a fascinating quirk of language evolution.

We use good and bad so constantly that the old irregular forms survive through **pure repetition.**

Extinct Words

The word **worser** died out in the 18th century.

We just did not need the extra form.

Rare words like 'punctual' are not spoken enough to protect an **irregular version**.



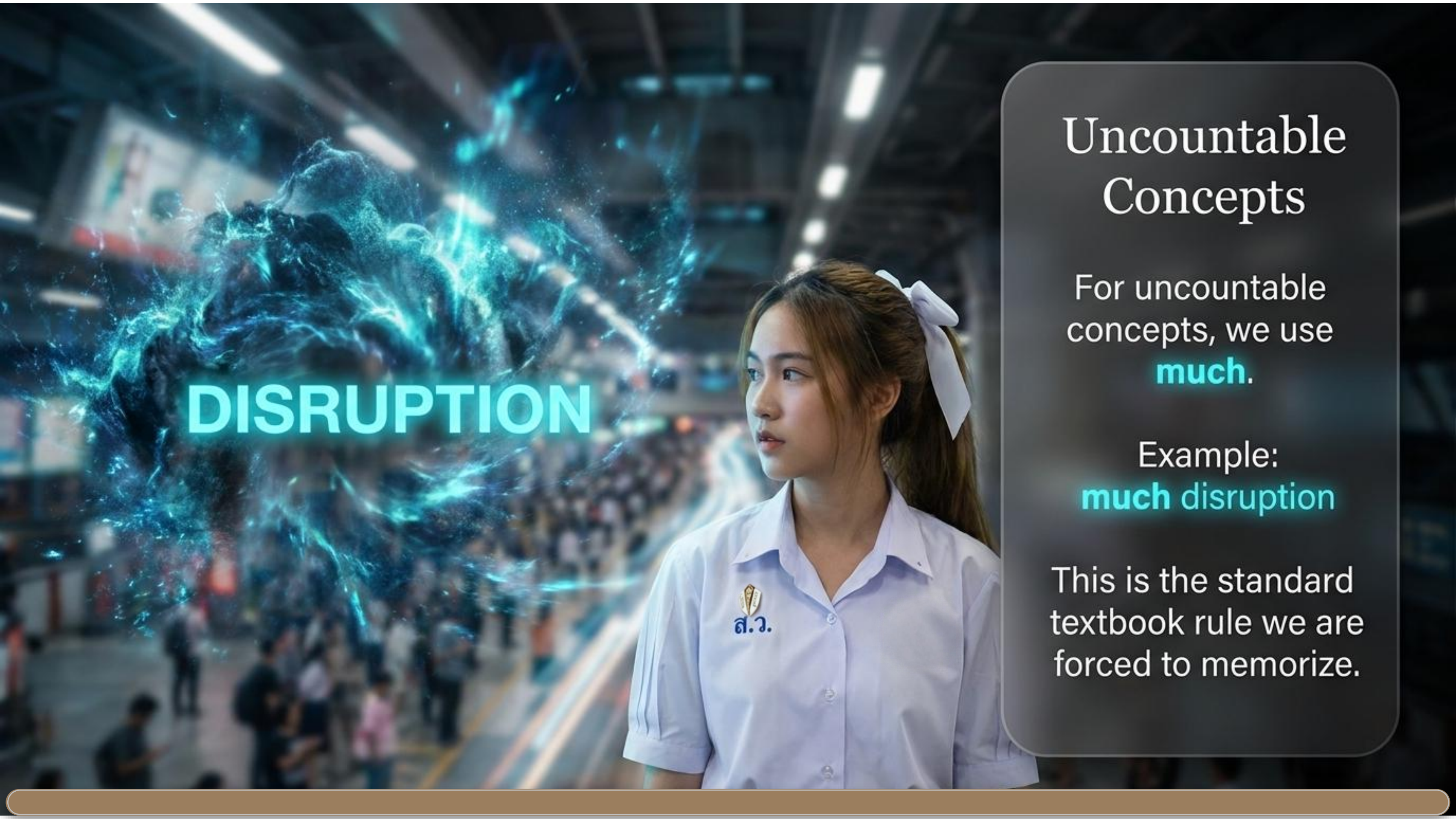
The Strict Separation

Standard rules teach us to strictly separate countable nouns from uncountable ones.

For countable items, we use **many**.

Example: **many trains**



A young woman with brown hair tied in a ponytail with a white bow, wearing a light blue school uniform shirt with a small crest and Thai text on the left chest, stands in the foreground. She is looking towards a large, glowing blue energy cloud that resembles a massive explosion or a powerful magical effect. The cloud is composed of many smaller, swirling blue particles and is set against a blurred background of a large crowd of people in a stadium or arena, with bright lights visible in the distance.

DISRUPTION

Uncountable Concepts

For uncountable concepts, we use **much**.

Example:
much disruption

This is the standard textbook rule we are forced to memorize.



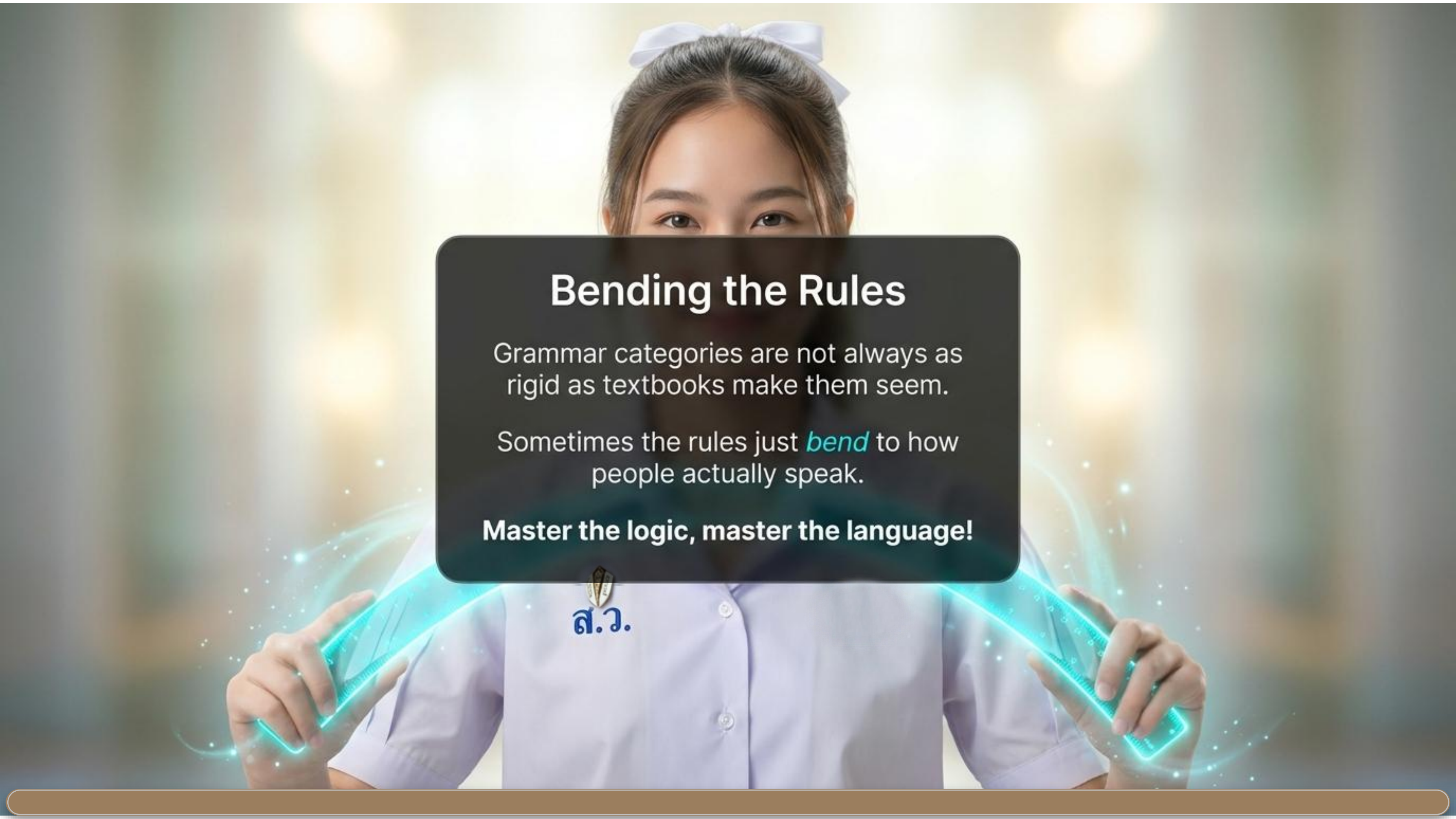
The Rule Vanishes

When you move **up the scale** to compare things, the strict rule vanishes.

We just use one form for both: **more**.

Example: **more trains**

and **more disruption**.

A young woman with dark hair tied back with a white bow, wearing a light blue school uniform. She is holding two glowing blue rulers, one in each hand, which are emitting a bright blue light. A dark, rounded rectangular text box is overlaid on her face, containing text about grammar rules. The background is a soft, out-of-focus bokeh of warm lights.

Bending the Rules

Grammar categories are not always as rigid as textbooks make them seem.

Sometimes the rules just *bend* to how people actually speak.

Master the logic, master the language!

ส.ว.